

unique feature, a handwriting recognition software, never recognised the user's handwriting spelling disaster for the product.

In 1991, realising that it needs to up the ante Apple decided to form an alliance with two of its major competitors, IBM and Motorola and formed the AIM Alliance. The aim behind this alliance (see what we did there) was to create a computing platform based on IBM and Motorola hardware mated with software designed by Apple. 'PowerPC' was the line of processors that were tailor-made for this range and dubbed 'PReP' or 'PowerPC Reference Platform'.

Money is Power

In 1994, 'Power Macintosh' was released featuring the PowerPC processor. The Power Mac became Apple's top offering and easily surpassed Intel's processors that had sort of become the industry standard by then.



The PowerPC processor became Apple's standard processor.

Spindler, who by now had settled in rather well, was worse than Scully when he had just taken over. A lot of not-so-nice things were said about his personality and the same person who had previously axed Apple's plans of licensing the Mac OS decided to start giving it out. Sure, Apple's market share rose to 10 percent by 1995, but it was hopeless at meeting demand and had about a billion dollars in backorders.

Misjudging the market, it also pushed the 'Macintosh Performa', released as a low end offering in 1992 instead of the Power Mac. Apple suffered losses and Spindler was asked to step down in January 1996.

Spindler was replaced by Gilbert Amelio. As president of National Semiconductor, Amelio had earned a reputation as a turnaround artist. He had successfully taken National Semiconductor, an unreliable tier-three chip manufacturer, right to the top. As Apple's new CEO, Amelio immediately started turning the frowns on shareholders' faces upside down. Amelio managed to turn losses exceeding \$700 million to about \$33 million in just a quarter. The following quarter was even better as Apple posted profits of roughly the same amount.